Kinonia te Eme

Elia

INTRODUCTION

Mitaeme is an international auxiliary language, or IAL—a culturally-neutral bridge between the various languages of the world. It draws most of its vocabulary from the world's largest languages: English, Mandarin Chinese, Hindustani, Spanish, Arabic, French, Bengali, Portuguese, Indonesian, Russian, German, Japanese, Nigerian Pidgin, Marathi, Vietnamese, Telugu, Swahili, and Hausa. In addition, it draws from a variety of other languages, including Turkish, Tagalog, Tamil, and Farsi.

The grammar of the language is based on the most common and easily-learned elements of these languages. There's no need to memorize tables of conjugations or rare exceptions to rules: Mitaeme has half as many consonants as English; only five vowels, like Spanish; and a simple, flexible grammar.

Having built a career around the development of technologies for the preservation and promotion of minoritized and endangered languages, it is important to me to stress that Mitaeme is not designed to replace one's own language(s) but provide a more neutral medium for community and collaboration. Please, learn another language before you learn Mitaeme.

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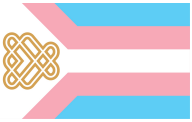
All art and all knowledge ought to be open and free.

Dedications



This work is dedicated to the fight for transsex liberation around the world.

Access to healthcare, community, and safety are systematically stripped from transsex individuals by all extant governments. All we have is each other.

You are my sisters and brothers, my siblings in light. I love you.

About the Author

My name is Elya Brown, and I'm a computational linguist and writer. I received my M.S. in Computational Linguistics from Indiana University in 2025, where I worked primarily on natural language processing for Standard and Classical Tibetan.

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CONSONANTS & VOWELS

Mitaeme features **twelve consonants**. In this textbook, the letter used to write each consonant will be included between angle brackets, , while the pronunciation will be written in the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) and placed between forward slashes, /.../. For each sound, we will provide a rough example in Standard American English.

⟨m⟩ /m/ “mail”	⟨n⟩ /n/ “nail”		
⟨p⟩ /p/ “pin”	⟨t⟩ /t/ “tin”	⟨c⟩ /t͡ʃ ~ ʃ/ “chin” ~ “shin”	⟨k⟩ /k/ “kin”
⟨f⟩ /ɸ ~ f/ “fed”	⟨s⟩ /s/ “said”		⟨h⟩ /x ~ h/ “head”
⟨w⟩ /w ~ v/ “wack”	⟨l⟩ /l/ “lack”	⟨y⟩ /j/ “yak”	

In addition to these, there are **five vowels**. Two examples are given: first in Standard American English and then in Spanish, as the five vowels of Mitaeme do not align well with those in English but align perfectly with those in Spanish (or Japanese, Tamil, and so on).

⟨i⟩ /i/ “leak” “pira”	⟨u⟩ /u/ “boot” “curso”
⟨e⟩ /e/ “speck” “pero”	⟨o⟩ /o/ “boat” “corso”
⟨a⟩ /a/ “hand” “casa”	

If you can’t quite pronounce each of these letters at first, don’t worry! They should come naturally with a little practice. Try listening to recordings of the pronunciation of Spanish, Tamil, Indonesian, or Tagalog vowels.

SPELLING

All sounds in Mitaeme are written with exactly one letter, and each letter is only ever pronounced exactly one way—with the slight exception of /j/ and /w/.

In a syllable, when /j/ or /w/ appear after a consonant or vowel, they are written ⟨i⟩ and ⟨u⟩ respectively. Thus, /koj/ is written ⟨koi⟩ and /t͡ʃjaw/ is written ⟨ciau⟩.

However, across syllables, this rule does not apply, so /an.ja/ is written ⟨anya⟩ instead of *⟨ania⟩.

This helps the reader distinguish between ⟨anya⟩ /an.ja/ and ⟨ania⟩ /a.nja/ which would otherwise both be written the same. This becomes important for recognizing the different parts of compound words.

Finally, /n/ is written ⟨m⟩ and pronounced as /m/ whenever it appears before /m/, /p/, or /w/. Thus, you can have a word like ⟨kompiuta⟩ /kom.pju.ta/ but never *⟨konpiuta⟩.

The R-Sound

Mitaeme features one extra sound that, as a rule, never appears in general vocabulary. It is only ever used for proper names of people, places, cultures, etc. This sound is ⟨r⟩ /ɾ/ which is pronounced like the 'r' in Spanish "pero" or, in most American English dialects, the 'tt' in "butter."

This sound only exists so that Mitaeme can borrow words like मराठी (marāṭhī) as ⟨Marati⟩ and Росси́я (Rossíja) as ⟨Rasiya⟩.

Punctuation

The first letter of each sentence is capitalized: ⟨M N P T C K F S H W L Y R⟩ and ⟨I E A U O⟩. In addition, proper names may be capitalized.

The period, ⟨.⟩, is used at the end of sentences. The exclamation mark, ⟨!⟩, may be used for exclamatory phrases and interjections! And the question mark, ⟨?⟩, is used at the end of questions.

Finally, the hyphen, ⟨-⟩, is used between the different parts of a compound word. When a word is common and relatively unambiguous, the hyphen may be dropped, as in ⟨motosaikale⟩, "motorcycle." Conversely, some highly-frequent adjective-noun pairs such as the pronoun, ⟨ta ni⟩ "y'all," may appear hyphenated: ⟨ta-ni⟩.

EXTRA: SYLLABLES

Mitaeme features **seventeen** unique sounds. However, instead of going one-by-one through these, we are going to lay out the four parts of a syllable and the different sounds that can appear in each. These parts include: twelve **initials** (ω), two **medials** (μ), five **vowels** (ν), and one **final** (κ).

The syllable in Mitaeme is structured like so:

Initial	1st Medial	Vowel	2nd Medial	Final
ω	μ	ν	μ	κ
{ m n p t c k f s h w l y }	{ i u }	{ i e a u o }	{ i u }	{ n }

Importantly, there are a few restrictions on syllable structure which narrow down the number of possibilities:

1. The first medial may only appear when there is an initial, but it cannot appear when that initial is ⟨y⟩ or ⟨w⟩. So ⟨kia⟩ but never *⟨yia⟩.

2. The same letter may never appear twice, next to each other, in the same syllable. In other words, neither the first nor second medial can be ⟨i⟩ when the vowel is ⟨i⟩. Similarly, neither medial can be ⟨u⟩ when the vowel is ⟨u⟩. So, ⟨kia⟩ but never *⟨kii⟩ , and ⟨kua⟩ but never *⟨kuu⟩.

3. If there is a first medial, the syllable may only have a second medial or a final, never both. So ⟨kiau⟩ or ⟨kian⟩ but never *⟨kiaun⟩.

4. The sequences ⟨iu⟩ and ⟨ui⟩ always represent a medial followed by vowel, never a vowel followed by a medial.

5. Before ⟨m⟩, ⟨p⟩, and ⟨w⟩, the final is ⟨n⟩ written and pronounced as ⟨m⟩. So ⟨kompu⟩ but never *⟨konpu⟩. Similarly, the final ⟨n⟩ is pronounced like the 'ng' in "sing" when it appears before ⟨k⟩, but its spelling remains the same.

6. Lastly, a non-compound word cannot contain a syllable ending in a vowel followed by a syllable beginning with a vowel. So, ⟨kahe⟩ but never *⟨kae⟩.

Altogether, these rules mean that the total number of possible syllables in Mitaeme is around **462** and each syllable is never more than **4** sounds long. In addition, the spelling of a word is never ambiguous: you always know how to pronounce a word given its spelling and vice versa.

PRACTICE 1: SPELLING

1. Transcribe the following pronunciations into Mitaeme spelling:

   /man te men e.lja/

   /a.la tej ta man saj.ka.le a.le a pu.ka ka.sa/

   /ni ko.me te.ke ni te a.tja.jan ma/

   /man le mun.t͡ʃe t͡ʃjan a lu.na/

2. Transcribe the following spellings into Mitaeme pronunciation:

   Ta-man le sammama na ale a kasa.

   Man hatie cueci Tamila.

   Yena yan solen ale a aiki a Pilipina.

   Man te sikana-cia katiki a Nepale.

3. Memorize the following alphabet:

Mi mi	Ni ni		
Pe pe	Te te		Ke ke
		Ce ce	
Fa fa	Sa sa		Ha ha
Wu wu	Lu lu	Yu yu	
	Ro ro		

I i	E e	A a	U u	O o

DIALOGUE & VOCABULARY

Yan A: Kai tali!

Yan B: Kai tali! Ni te men ma?

Yan A: Man te men Erin. I ni?

Yan B: Man te men Kuancin. Ni famwen teke ma-meta?

Yan A: Man teke Kalifonia. Ni katiki a ti ma?

Yan B: Na, man te kasa a Peicin.

Person A: Hello!

Person B: Hello! What is your name?

Person A: My name is Erin. And you?

Person B: My name is Guangxin. Where are you visiting from?

Person A: I am from California. Do you live here?

Person B: No, my home is in Beijing.

Vocabulary	Pronunciation	Part of Speech	Meaning	
kai tali	/kaj ta.li/	interj.	greetings, hello	
man	/man/	pron.	I, me	1SG
ni	/ni/	pron.	you (1)	2SG
ye	/je/	pron.	they, she, he (1)	3SG
ta man	/ta.man/	pron.	we, us	1PL
ta ni	/ta.ni/	pron.	you (2+)	2PL
ta ye	/ta.je/	pron.	they (2+)	3PL
men	/men/	n.	name	
kasa	/ka.sa/	n.	house, home	
famwen	/fam.wen/	v.	to visit	
katiki	/ka.ti.ki/	v.	to live	
ti	/ti/	adj. / n.	this, here	PROX
yena	/je.na/	adj. / n.	that, there (near)	MEDI
akeli	/a.ke.li/	adj. / n.	that, there (far)	DIST
a	/a/	prep.	at, on, to	
teke	/te.ke/	prep.	from, of, out of	
te	/te/	part.	genitive	GEN
ma	/ma/	part.	interrogative	INT
i	/i/	part.	coordinator	COORD

FREE WORDS

Free Parts of Speech

Words never change form. There are no prefixes or suffixes and no changes to roots.

A language like English will sometimes use affixes to indicate grammatical features—we often make a noun plural in this way: “car” to “cars,” where the suffix ‘-s’ indicates the plural form. Similarly, we sometimes make changes to the root: “mouse” to “mice.”

Mitaeme never does this. Instead, extra words are added to sentences to convey more complex meaning. Words may either be **free**, not relying on other words to appear, or **bound**, relying on other words. There are three basic types of free words:

A **verb** refers to an action, occurrence, or state: “to know,” “to have,” “to understand,” and so on.

Ta-man **ale** a kasa.

ta-man	**ale**	a	kasa
we	**go**	to	house

We are going to the house.

An **adjective** refers to a quality: “green,” “blue,” “heavy,” “good,” “old,” and so on. Adjectives may also act as adverbs, when semantically applicable. Adjectives always appear directly before the word they modify.

Ti **umai** kafe.

ti	**umai**	kafe
this	**delicious**	coffee

This is delicious coffee.

A **noun** refers to a person, place, thing, or concept: “woman,” “garden,” “spoon,” “beauty,” and so on. Nouns also include pronouns like “I,” “you,” and “they.”

Ni tinke **palu**.

ni	tinke	**palu**
you	drink	**milk**

You are drinking milk.

Bound Parts of Speech

There are two additional parts of speech that can only appear when they are attached to another word or phrase: prepositions and particles.

A **preposition** creates a relationship between a noun and other parts of the sentence. Usually, this relationship has to do with location, time, direction, or manner. Prepositions are words like "in," "at," "on," "while," and so on. Prepositions always appear before the noun, with other words like adjectives and possessors that modify the same noun appearing between the preposition and the modified word.

Ta-ye ale **a** ca-kasa **teke** kasa.

ta-ye	ale	**a**	aiki-meta	**teke**	kasa	
they (2+)		go	**to**	workplace	**from**	home

They are going to work from home.

Particles add information and connect phrases. In Mitaeme, this includes words like "no," "that," "and," as well as possessive and question markers. Particles can appear at the beginning of ends of sentences or before the verb they modify, with adverbs placed between the particle and verb.

Ye **te** auto **le** osoi ale **ma**?

ye	**te**	auto	**le**	osoi	ale	**ma**
they	**GEN**	car	**PST**	slow	go	**INT**

Did their car go slowly?

Te – The Genitive Particle

The particle, ⟨te⟩, marks the "genitive"—appearing after a noun and indicating possession, origin, or composition. The possessor is the modified noun, with the possessee appearing after the particle.

In English, we usually indicate the possessive meaning by writing "-'s" as in "the dog's tail" or by using the preposition "of" as in "the house of the doctor." In Mitaeme, this is achieved by placing ⟨te⟩ between the possessor and what is possessed.

Ti man **te** cota kasa.

ti	man	**te**	cota	kasa
this	I	**GEN**	small	house

This is my small house.

Like “of,” ⟨te⟩ can be used to indicate composition as in: “a boat (made) of wood.” In addition, this can indicate what a container is filled with.

Yena cala **te** piala.
yena cala **te** piala
that water **GEN** cup
That is a cup of water.

Akeli lennio **te** kasa.
akeli lennio **te** kasa
that wood **GEN** house
That is a house (made) of wood.

Finally, ⟨te⟩ can indicate origin. This is similar to the “from” in English phrases such as “the person from Quebec” or “the woman from Spain.”

Ye Epania **te** yan.
ye Epania **te** yan
they Spain **GEN** person
They are a Spanish person.

Man Intonesia **te**.
man Intonesia **te**
I Indonesia **GEN**
I am Indonesian.

Ma – The Interrogative Particle

Questions always contain the particle ⟨ma⟩, which marks the sentence as such.

⟨Ma⟩ may also be compounded with nouns to form question words like “what” or “how.” For example, ⟨ma-meta⟩ “where” sees ⟨ma⟩ combined with ⟨meta⟩ “place.” Similarly, ⟨ma-aika⟩ “when” sees it combined with ⟨aika⟩ “time.” Any noun may be combined with ⟨ma⟩ to form the meaning “which / what ___.” For example, ⟨imahen⟩ “picture” becomes ⟨ma-imahen⟩ “which picture.”

Ni le ale a **ma**-kasa?
ni le ale a **ma**-kasa
you PST go to **INT**-house
Which house did you go to?

I – The Coordinating Conjunction

The coordinating conjunction, ⟨i⟩, is used like “and” to connect nouns, phrases, and sentences.

Man le ale a satu-kasa **i** pai wino.

man	le	ale	a	satu-kasa	**i**	pai	wino
I	PST	go	to	store	**and**	buy	wine

I went to the store and bought wine.

PRACTICE 2: PARTS OF SPEECH

1. Indicate the part-of-speech of the highlighted word in each sentence:

Mau **pei** hota pa hauci-noi.

mau	**pei**	hota	pa	hauci-noi
cat	PV	kill	by	curiosity

The cat was killed by curiosity.

Tunia tatia te ta-noi.

tunia	tatia	te	ta-noi
world	fact	gen	totality

The world is the totality of facts.

Ni nesesite **hase** wa o-ke ni cian.

ni	nesesite	**hase**	wa	o-ke	ni	cian
you	need	do	thing	about_which	you	say

You need to do as you say.

Ta-ye le **mienki** luo tonkuo anki.

ta-ye	le	**mienki**	luo	tonkuo	anki
they	PST	soft	fall	through	universe

They fell softly through the universe.

2. Fill in the empty space in each sentence with the proper particle: ⟨te⟩, ⟨ma⟩, or ⟨i⟩.

Man ___ men Minato.

Ye katiki a ti ___ man famwen.

Man katiki a yena kasa ___?

Ta-ye ___ famwen teke Kolompia?

DIALOGUE & VOCABULARY

Yan A: Koi koi! Man na iya tinke man te ca na o-ke ye sahin.

Person A: Excuse me! I cannot drink my tea because it is hot.

Yan B: A! Man ale pana palu o-ke citala-hase ye.

Person B: Oh! I will go get milk in order to cool it down.

Yan A: Koi koi.

Person A: Thank you.

Yan B: Ti-so. Samaha man.

Person B: Here you go. I'm sorry.

Yan A: Na pentin. Man ale pai keike tampien, koi koi. Ni te keike kai umai.

Person A: It's nothing. I will also buy cake, please. Your cake is very tasty.

Yan B: So so. Man kome hafe ni te keike.

Person B: Of course. I'll bring your cake.

Vocabulary	Pronunciation	Part of Speech	Meaning
koi	/koj/	interj.	please, thank you, excuse me
ti-so	/ti.so/	interj.	here you go, there you go
ca	/t͡ʃa/	n.	tea
palu	/pa.lu/	n.	milk
keike	/kej.ke/	n.	cake
hase	/ha.se/	v.	to do, to make
iya	/i.ja/	v.	to be able, to know how to
kome	/ko.me/	v.	to come
hafe	/ha.fe/	v.	to have, to possess
tinke	/tiŋ.ke/	v.	to drink
samaha	/sa.ma.ha/	v.	to forgive, to pardon
kai	/kaj/	adj.	many, much, often
sahin	/sa.hin/	adj.	hot, warm, heated
citala	/t͡ʃi.ta.la/	adj.	cold, cool, cooled
umai	/u.maj/	adj.	tasty, delicious
pentin	/pen.tin/	adj.	important, key, major
o	/o/	prep.	for, about, in order to
ke	/ke/	part.	that, relativizer REL
so	/so/	part.	yes, affirmative AFF
na	/na/	part.	no, negative NEG

SUBJECT & OBJECT

The Subject

Every sentence has at least two parts: the **subject** and the verb. The subject is the noun about which the statement is made and is usually the one performing the verb. The subject always comes before the verb, though it may be elided if it is obvious given context. The subject is not marked by a particle or preposition.

The passive particle, ⟨pei⟩, makes it so that the semantic object is elevated to the position of the grammatical subject. In simpler terms, this means that the old subject is dropped (or included with the preposition, ⟨pa⟩ "by") and the old object is moved up to replace the it, making it the new subject.

Man le ci pala a kasa.

man	le	ci	pala	a	kasa
I	PST	eat	fruit	at	home

I ate fruit at home.

A kasa, **pala** le pei ci pa man.

a	kasa	**pala**	le	pei	ci	pa	man
at	home	**fruit**	PST	PV	eat	INSTR	I

At home, fruit was eaten by me.

The Object

Certain verbs require an object: the noun which the verb is being done to. These always follow the verb. The object is also known as the "direct object," in contrast to the "indirect object." The object, like the subject, is not marked by a particle or preposition.

As stated above, the object may replace the subject by modifying the verb with the passive particle, ⟨pei⟩.

Man ai **ni**.

man	ai	**ni**
I	love	**you**

I love you.

Akeli yan le leka man te atiayan te **puka**.

akeli	yan	le	leka	man	te	atiayan	te	**puka**
DIST	person	PST	write	I	GEN	course	GEN	**book**

That person wrote my course's book.

The Indirect Object

Some verbs—such as “to give”—allow an indirect object: the noun which is the recipient of the action. In Mitaeme, the indirect object is marked by the preposition, ⟨a⟩ “at / to.”

Ni te mita le tewa tinke-wa **a ni**.

ni	te	mita	le	tewa	tinke-wa	**a**	**ni**
you	GEN	friend	PST	give	drink	**to**	**you**

Your friend gave the drink to you.

Word Order

The word order of Mitaeme is SVO, or subject-verb-object. If there is an indirect object, it comes after the direct object.

Commands are formed by dropping the subject so that the word order becomes VO, as in:

Ale a kasa!

ale	a	kasa
go	to	home

Go home!

Ci ni te ci-wa.

ci	ni	te	ci-wa
eat	you	GEN	food

Eat your food!

As Mitaeme does not have a copula—“to be”—the general way to create such a construction is simply to use an SO word order, as in:

Yena yan leka-cia.

yena	yan	leka-cia
MEDI	person	author

That person is an author.

PRACTICE 3: WORD ORDER

...

DIALOGUE & VOCABULARY

Yan A: Man tei kome hafe keike.

Person A: I'm bringing the cake now.

Yan B: Ni mei usa yena naife kate keike.

Person B: Why don't you use that knife to cut the cake?

Yan A: Man iya usa ti! Ti osa o ni. Ti osa o ye. I ti osa o man. Ta-yan hafe keike ma?

Person A: I can use this one. This pieces is for you. This piece is for them. And this piece is for me. Everyone has cake?

Yan B: Umai ne? Ni sahi patai ti ma? Au ni le pai ye?

Person B: This is delicious, right? You really made this? Or did you buy it?

Yan A: Ti tu hannu sahi patai yena keike ke ni ci.

Person A: These two hands really made that cake you're eating.

Yan B: Ala-tei, ni ale sita sikana patai ti a man ma?

Person B: Will you sit and teach me how to make this tomorrow?

Vocabulary	Pronunciation	Part of Speech	Meaning	
yan	/jan/	n.	person, human being	
keike	/kej.ke/	n.	cake (desert)	
naife	/naj.fe/	n.	knife (tool / utensil)	
osa	/o.sa/	n.	part, piece	
hannu	/han.nu/	n.	hand (body part)	
tei	/tej/	n.	day	
ala-tei	/a.la tej/	n.	tomorrow	
iya	/i.ja/	v.	to be able to / can	
usa	/u.sa/	v.	to use	
kate	/ka.te/	v.	to cut	
ci	/t͡ʃi/	v.	to eat	
sita	/si.ta/	v.	to sit	
sikana	/si.ka.na/	v.	to teach, to instruct	
ai	/aj/	v.	to love, to adore	
ala	/a.la/	adj.	next, subsequent	
sahi	/sa.hi/	adj.	true, honest, correct, real	
au	/aw/	part.	disjunctive	DISJ
mei	/mej/	part.	optative	OPT
tei	/tej/	part.	continuous	CONT

Verb Chains

Verb chains are constructions wherein verbs are placed one after another in order to convey a complex series of events.

Ta-man tei ale sita kan kino.

ta-man	tei	ale	sita	kan	kino
we	CONT	walk	sit	watch	movie

We are walking to go sit and watch a movie.

Man le hoisi pau takoi ye.

man	le	hoisi	pau	takoi	ye
I	PST	start	run	meet	they

I started to run to meet them.

Sometimes, verb chains are used to convey a single event, as in:

Man le kome hafe saikale.

man	le	kome	hafe	saikale
I	PST	come	have	bicycle

I brought a bike.

When an object comes after one verb and before another, it serves as either the subject or the instrument, tool, or means of achieving the subsequent verb, as in:

Usa mi te fon cian ni te mama.

usa	mi	te	fon	cian	ni	te	mama
use	I	GEN	phone	speak	you	GEN	mother

Use my phone to talk to your mom.

Laki le kome hafe puka leka a kafe-kasa.

laki	le	kome	hafe	puka	leka	a	kafe-kasa
man	PST	come	have	book	read	at	cafe

The man brought the book to read at the cafe.

When a particle modifies a particular verb in a verb chain (rather than modifying the whole series of verbs), it must come directly before it.

Mei – The Optative Particle

The particle, ⟨mei⟩, marks the "optative"—essentially, it indicates when the speaker wishes that the action would occur. The phrase "Long Live the Revolution!" is an optative phrase expressing the speaker's hope for a long-lived revolution, as is "God grant me strength!" Another way to express the optative in English is "may," as in: "may he see the error of his ways."

Ye mei kiakia leka puka.				
ye	mei	kiakia	leka	puka
she	OPT	quick	write	book
May she write the book quickly.				

This particle also serves much the same function as English "let's" as in "let's go to the store." In other words, it is used for encouragement or weak command. In linguistics, this is known as the hortative (HORT).

Ni mei na hatie sita yena.					
ni	mei	na	hatie	sita	yena
you	HORT	NEG	want	sit	MEDI
You may not want to sit there.					

Tei – The Present Continuous Particle

The particle, ⟨tei⟩, marks the explicit "present continuous." Usually, you don't need to add any extra words to indicate that an action is occurring in the present or that it is ongoing: this is conveyed through context. However, in cases where you do need to explicitly signal that an action is ongoing at the moment, you use this particle.

Man tei ale a kasa.				
man	tei	ale	a	kasa
I	CONT	go	to	home
I am going home (right now).				

PRACTICE 4: VERB CHAINS

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SECTION